Five public starting points for Singapore AI.

28 SEPTEMBER 2026 PUBLIC SOURCES STARTING MAP

A first pass at the question: where should someone begin when they want to understand the country's AI ecosystem?

By Superintelligence SG · Published 28 September 2026 · Version 1.2
Editorial analysis of public sources. Observations and interpretation are presented separately.

The question

Where should someone begin when they want to understand Singapore's AI ecosystem?

The map is easier to read as a set of entry points.

Singapore's AI landscape is not one list. Public programmes, research institutions, assurance work, adoption support and public-service capability answer different questions. This note puts those doors side by side so a reader can choose the next source to open.

What we observed.

The public record clusters around five jobs: build national capability, extend the research frontier, make systems testable, help organizations adopt AI in practice and equip public servants to redesign and deliver services with AI.

That structure is useful because it separates roles without pretending the boundaries are fixed. One institution can appear in more than one layer; this page records the

public role described by its source.

Five starting points.

Each row names a public source, the structure it reveals and the next question it leaves open.

01 / CAPABILITY

AI Singapore connects research, companies and talent.

AI Singapore describes a national programme that brings together Singapore-based research institutions and an ecosystem of start-ups and companies to perform use-inspired research, create tools and grow talent.

Read AI Singapore's public overview ↗
(https://aisingapore.org/)

WHY IT MATTERS

This is a useful entry point for capability, programmes and talent. It does not tell us every organization working in Singapore.

02 / RESEARCH

NUS AI Institute makes the research layer legible.

The Institute groups its work into foundational AI, AI + X, and AI governance and policy, linking technical research to sectors and public questions.

Read NUS AI Institute's research map ↗
(https://ai.nus.edu.sg/research/)

WHY IT MATTERS

A research map helps a reader move from “who is doing AI?” to “what kind of question is being worked on?”

03 / ASSURANCE

AI Verify Foundation turns trust into a testing layer.

The Foundation describes an open-source community for AI testing frameworks, tools and practices, including the Global AI Assurance Sandbox for real-world generative AI applications.

Read AI Verify Foundation's public work ↗
(https://aiverifyfoundation.sg/)

WHY IT MATTERS

Assurance is infrastructure for adoption. It gives builders and deployers a place to ask how a system behaves, not only what it promises.

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04 / ADOPTION

IMDA's National AI Impact Programme frames adoption as capability.

IMDA says the 2026 programme will support enterprises and workers, including a target of 10,000 enterprises and 100,000 AI-bilingual workers over three years.

Read IMDA's programme factsheet ↗
(https://www.imda.gov.sg/resources/press-releases-factsheets-and-speeches/factsheets/2026/national-ai-impact-programme)

WHY IT MATTERS

Adoption is not only a vendor list. It includes skills, workflow change and the institutions that make implementation possible.

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05 / PUBLIC SERVICE

The Institute of Digital Government makes AI capability part of public-service delivery.

MDDI says the Institute of Digital Government, launched with the Civil Service College, will equip more than 150,000 public officers with practical digital, data and AI capabilities by the end of 2028. Its structured pathways and AI Sprints are designed to help officers test approaches, redesign workflows and scale useful practices across agencies.

Read MDDI's IDG announcement ↗
(https://www.mddi.gov.sg/newsroom/new-institute-of-digital-government-to-build-an-ai-ready-public-service/)

WHY IT MATTERS

Public-sector AI capability is more than policy. It includes the practical learning and workflow conditions needed to use technology in domain work.

What the first map leaves out.

This is a public starting map, not a census. It does not yet show the full set of private vendors, community groups, funders, specialist labs or the lived outcomes of deployment. Those gaps are invitations for better sources, not missing rankings.

Sources used.

AI Singapore

Public overview of programmes, research and talent.
(https://aisingapore.org/)

NUS AI Institute

Research areas and governance work.
(https://ai.nus.edu.sg/research/)

AI Verify Foundation

Public assurance, testing and open-source work.
(https://aiverifyfoundation.sg/)

IMDA

National AI Impact Programme factsheet, 2 March 2026.
(https://www.imda.gov.sg/resources/press-releases-factsheets-and-speeches/factsheets/2026/national-ai-impact-programme)

MDDI / Institute of Digital Government

Official launch release, 18 September 2026.
(https://www.mddi.gov.sg/newsroom/new-institute-of-digital-government-to-build-an-ai-ready-public-service/)

Version and corrections

1.2 · 29 October 2026 — Added the Institute of Digital Government as a fifth public starting point, based on MDDI's 18 September 2026 release. The original publication date is retained.

1.1 · 28 September 2026 — Added citation tools, a downloadable brief and links to the related public index. The research claims are unchanged from version 1.0.

1.0 · 28 September 2026 — Initial publication based on the sources listed above.

Have a correction or a missing primary source? Contact the editor. Changes to findings will be recorded here.